

JERMAL M. SMITH

IT & Security Leader | Enterprise Infrastructure · Cloud · Cybersecurity · Digital Transformation

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

IT and Security leader with 20+ years leading enterprise technology functions in regulated, global SaaS environments. Proven track record owning \$4M+ annual IT budgets, building and scaling high-performing teams, and delivering clean SOC 2, ISO 27001, and ISO 9001 audit outcomes across multiple cycles with zero major findings. Trusted strategic partner to C-suite and CTO leadership to align technology investment with business outcomes through structured IT roadmaps, Zero Trust security architecture, and enterprise-wide digital transformation. Experienced across M&A integration, global workforce enablement, and regulated Life Sciences compliance (HIPAA, GDPR, CFR 11). Balances executive-level strategic direction with deep technical credibility across cloud, infrastructure, and cybersecurity.

CORE COMPETENCIES

IT Operations Leadership • Enterprise Architecture • Cloud Platforms (Azure, AWS, M365) Cybersecurity & Zero Trust
SOC 2 • ISO 27001 • ISO 9001 • HIPAA • GDPR • CFR 11 • NIST / CIS Frameworks • Identity & Access Management
Budget Ownership & Cost Optimization • Vendor & Contract Strategy • Digital Transformation • M&A Integration
Team Development & Talent Management • Business Continuity & DR • Automation & IaC • Agile / Scrum

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sparta Systems, a Honeywell Company • Hamilton, NJ

2015 – Present

Senior Manager, Information Technology

2020 – Present

Led global IT operations, infrastructure, cybersecurity, and compliance for a regulated Life Sciences SaaS business. Owned \$4M+ annual IT budget and a 15-person extended team. Served as strategic technology partner to the CTO across enterprise architecture, organizational transformation, and executive decision-making.

Strategy, Leadership & Business Impact

- Owned \$4M+ annual IT budget; drove vendor consolidation and licensing optimization that reduced overhead by an estimated 25–35%, reallocating spends toward cloud and security modernization.
- Defined and executed a multi-year IT strategy roadmap aligning infrastructure, cloud, and security investments with business growth targets and regulatory requirements across a 200+ person global organization.
- Steered IT through Honeywell's multi-entity acquisition sustaining 100% service continuity, preserving team engagement, and integrating operations across multiple geographies without disruption.
- Enabled WFH transformation for 400+ employees and stood up technology infrastructure for a new Center of Excellence in India, delivering both initiatives on schedule under compressed timelines.
- Led digital transformation initiative modernizing enterprise tooling and communication platforms consolidating vendors and standardizing the employee technology experience across a globally distributed workforce.

Security, Risk & Compliance

- Achieved zero major findings across SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001, and ISO 9001 audit cycles leading audit readiness, remediation governance, and cross-functional compliance alignment across multiple consecutive cycles.
- Architected and operationalized Zero Trust security framework across globally distributed infrastructure implementing identity governance, MFA enforcement, SSO integration, conditional access, and cloud security controls.
- Directed enterprise risk management program, improving visibility into operational, security, and compliance risk and driving executive-level mitigation planning aligned to NIST and CIS frameworks.
- Operationalized CAPA and SOP governance in a regulated Life Sciences environment, ensuring consistent audit readiness and timely remediation of platform and process gaps.

Platform Reliability & Incident Management

- Led enterprise incident and escalation management for a 24/7 SaaS platform improving response coordination, root-cause accountability, and communication clarity, contributing to measurable reduction in repeat incidents.
- Strengthened data governance and platform resilience through proactive risk identification, cross-team operational governance, and continuous improvement frameworks.

IT Manager

2018 – 2020

Managed a 7-person cross-functional IT team across infrastructure, operations, and enterprise systems. Owned full scope of IT service delivery, vendor strategy, and technology planning for a growing Life Sciences SaaS business.

- Built, coached, and retained a 7-person IT team establishing SLA frameworks, individual development plans, and performance KPIs that drove measurable improvements in delivery consistency and team engagement.
- Directed Microsoft 365 and Azure cloud adoption; administered Entra ID (Azure AD) at scale with RBAC, conditional access, and MFA significantly reducing identity-related risk across a 300+ user environment.
- Managed multi-million-dollar IT budget and vendor strategy; led build vs. buy evaluations and provided economic justification for major technology deployment decisions across business departments.
- Evaluated and implemented AWS and Azure hybrid infrastructure standards, contributing to scalable enterprise architecture and accelerating secure cloud adoption.

Expert Systems Administrator

2015 – 2018

- Designed and maintained VMware vSphere and Hyper-V enterprise virtualization; architected SAN/NAS environments (Nimble, Dell EqualLogic, TrueNAS); led datacenter consolidation and DR design using Veeam, improving RTO/RPO targets.
- Built PowerShell, Ansible, and scripting automation frameworks; managed global networking including Checkpoint firewalls, Cisco switching/routing, Aruba wireless, and VPN infrastructure.

Infragistics • Cranbury, NJ

2007 – 2015

Senior Systems Administrator / Team Lead → Systems Administrator

2007 – 2015

- Managed Windows Server and Linux (RHEL/Debian) environments supporting global SaaS infrastructure across multiple data centers; administered VMware/Hyper-V, SAN/NAS, and Veeam backup ensuring high availability.
- Designed and maintained enterprise network infrastructure (Cisco, firewall, VPN); led Active Directory and identity management including RBAC, group policy, and directory integration.
- Developed PowerShell automation for patch management, provisioning, and monitoring; mentored junior admins and supported security operations including vulnerability scanning and incident response.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Systems / Network Administrator WeGuardYou, Manalapan, NJ (2003–2007)

ISP domain and realm administration; primary administrator for hosted web and dial-up services; internal network, computer support, backup, and data recovery.

Software Developer / Consultant Cap Gemini Ernst & Young, Clark, NJ (1999–2001)

Consulted on VoIP telecom projects; provided client-side support and technical delivery during consulting engagements.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Identity: Azure, AWS, Microsoft 365, Entra ID (Azure AD), Azure AD Conditional Access, SSO/SAML, MFA

Infrastructure & Virtualization: VMware vSphere, Hyper-V, Proxmox VE, multi-site datacenter operations

Security & Networking: Checkpoint, Cisco, Juniper, Aruba, VPN, SD-WAN, Endpoint Protection, PAM, Zero Trust

Identity & Access Management: Active Directory, Entra ID, RBAC, Group Policy, SSO/SAML federation, PAM

Automation & IaC: PowerShell, Ansible, Terraform, Kubernetes, scripting pipelines

Storage & BC/DR: Nimble Storage, Dell EqualLogic, TrueNAS, SAN/NAS architecture, Veeam

OS: Windows Server 2008–2022, Windows 10/11, RHEL, Debian, Ubuntu

Frameworks & Compliance: ITIL, Agile/Scrum, SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001, ISO 9001, HIPAA, GDPR, CFR 11, NIST, CIS, CAPA

CERTIFICATIONS

VMware Certified Professional – Data Center Virtualization (VCP6-DCV) • VMware vExpert

Microsoft MCSE / MCSA • CompTIA Security+, Linux+, Server+, Network+

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

B.A., Sociology • Monmouth University

Computer Systems & Networking • New Horizons

Continuous learning in cloud architecture, cybersecurity, and enterprise leadership • Technology blogger at jermssmit.com (2007–Present)